

THE "RIGHT NOTE RULE"

FROM DIGGING DEEPER JAZZ VIDEO #30

- 1) Determine a chord change you want to work on, that you aren't "getting," etc.
 - 2) Determine the general key of the entire song.
 - 3) Identify the 3rd and 7th of the given chord (from #1 above).
 - 4) Identify which of those two notes are NOT in the key of the song (from #2 above).
 - 5) That is the note you HAVE TO PLAY on that chord when you are improvising.
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For Example -

- Say the 2nd bar is "a problem" in our playing.
- This song is in the key of "C" or "C7" (first chord is C7, last chord leads to C [a V-I], the second last bar is a C7).
- The 3rd of the F7 is the pitch "A" and the 7th is the pitch Eb.
- The pitch Eb is not in the key of C, so Eb is the pitch we MUST play in the 2nd bar.

The musical score consists of three staves of music in treble clef. The first staff contains bars 1 through 4, the second staff contains bars 5 through 8, and the third staff contains bars 9 through 12. Chord changes are indicated above each bar. In bars 3, 8, 10, and 12, boxes highlight the 3rd and 7th notes of the chord, with labels 'b7' and '3' respectively, indicating the notes to focus on for improvisation.

Another Example -

- The same reasoning applies in the 8th bar of the example - the A7 bar.
- The pitch C# (the 3rd of the A7 chord) is not in the key of C, so that is the note we MUST play in that bar.

And ANOTHER Example -

- The same reasoning applies in the 10th and 12th bar of the example - the G7 bar.
- The pitch B (the 3rd of the G7 chords) is not in the key of C7, so that is the note we MUST play in that bar. [This is a tricky one. Remember, a C blues isn't in the "key of C major." We are in the "key of C dominant," which has a Bb in it. The B natural pitch in the G7 chord is outside the key of C dominant].